

AI and the political economy of information filtering

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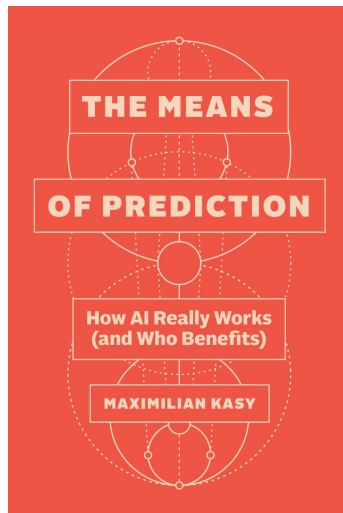
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Information filtering

- Important across domains
 - Statistics: Specification searching, p-hacking, publication bias.
 - News, search: Content filtering.
 - Social media, other platforms: Ad targeting, recommender systems.
- Selection is necessary:
 - Attention is limited, potential information is not.
- Selection criteria are not obvious:
 - Avoiding distortion? → Independence of content?
 - Downstream decisions? → Surprisingness?
 - Plausibility? → Unsurprisingness?
- Political economy: Who decides selection criteria, to what end?

The political economy of AI

1. AI is automated decision-making using *optimization*.
2. Key issue: Who gets to pick the *objectives* that AI optimizes? (Not: Did the AI fail to optimize?)
3. Power flows from control of AI *inputs*: data, compute, expertise, energy.
4. We need *democratic control* of AI objectives by those affected by AI decisions.



Workshop format

- Cross-disciplinary:
 - Econ theory, computer science, empirics, regulatory practice.
- Goal:
 - In-depth interaction.
 - New agendas across fields.
- To develop a shared understanding:
 1. Tutorial lectures.
 2. Frontier talks.
- Time for extended discussions after each talk.

Schedule - Tutorial lectures

- Monday, May 25
 - 12:00 Manish Raghavan: *Algorithmic and information monocultures*
 - 14:15 Homa Hosseinmardi: *Overexamined Algorithms and Overlooked Agency*
 - 16:00 Ananya Sen: *Generative AI and the Online Information Ecosystem: Early Evidence and Implications*
- Tuesday, May 26
 - 11:00 Benjamin Hébert: *Endogenous Information Acquisition in Strategic and Non-Strategic Settings*
 - 13:15 Simeon Thornton: *Online Information Filtering: A Regulator's Perspective*

Schedule - Frontier talks

- Tuesday, May 26
 - 15:00 Manish Raghavan: *AI, homogeneity, and incentives*
 - 17:00 Sendhil Mullainathan: *Sanjaya Lall Lecture*
- Wednesday, May 27
 - 9:15 Aarushi Kalra:
 - 11:00 Homa Hosseinmardi: *Reframing Algorithmic Harms through the Lens of User Behavior*
 - 13:15 Benjamin Hébert: *Engagement Maximization*
 - 15:00 Ananya Sen: *GenAI Misinformation, Trust, and News Consumption: Evidence from a Field Experiment*
 - 16:45 Simeon Thornton: *Information Filtering in Generative AI*

Thank you!